

Chimcare — URL Change Report

What our URLs are made of, and what the already-decided ones mean. Measured from the WordPress database and the approved decision files.
Read-only. 9 September 2026.

1. What a Chimcare URL is made of

Nearly every URL sits under `/location/` and names three things: a **service**, a **city** and a **state**.

<code>/location/chimney-sweep-in-seattle-wa/</code>
SERVICE CITY STATE

Checking all 262,987 URLs for how many carry each part:

The URL names...	URLs	Share
A service	262,987	100.0%
A state	262,837	99.9%
A city	258,583	98.3%
All three together	258,543	98.3%

The structure is more consistent than it looks. **Fewer than 2 in 100 URLs are missing a piece.** The problem is not that the pattern is absent, but that a small number break it in expensive ways.

2. The eight kinds of URL

Category	URLs	Clicks	What it is
Service + city + state	199,748	21,532	The standard pattern. Clean.
Not a live page	33,347	7,614	Only in the decision files; deleted from WordPress.
Same, but missing “in”	14,429	8,455	Older shape. Still readable.
Town hub page	5,377	19,126	A town’s main page, not a service page.
Duplicate –2 copy	5,052	361	WordPress made a second copy.
No city named	4,057	432	City missing from the address.
Editing note saved as a URL	972	29	Someone’s notes became a live page.
No state named	5	417	City and state stuck together.

Standard	/location/chimney-sweep-in-seattle-wa/	
Missing “in”	/location/chimney-sweep-seattle-wa/	1,927 clicks
Town hub	/location/chimney-sweep-repair-in-boston-ma/	1,236 clicks
Duplicate	/location/duct-cleaning-in-worcester-ma-2/	1 click
No city	/location/chimney-sweep-long-beach-wa/	50 clicks
No state	/location/cleveland-oh-chimney-sweep-repair/	307 clicks
Editing note	/location/heat-shield-repair-in-newton-ma-is-not-correct-since-the-first-variable-is-heatshield-not-heat-shield.../	

Take-away: 98.3% of URLs already contain state, city and service. The site is well structured. About 10,000 URLs break the pattern, and those are what make a URL change difficult — not the other 250,000.

The 89,815 already-decided URLs

URLs where the business has already chosen what happens. They split into two groups.

Decision	URLs	Meaning
REDIRECT	53,056	Send the visitor to a different page.
GONE	36,759	Retire the page. It should stop existing.
Total	89,815	The figure of 89,727 quoted earlier is close; the measured total today is 89,815.

3. The 53,056 redirects — where they come from

Source of the decision	URLs	What it is
The approved redirect file	50,938	Decisions made by the business.
Duplicate town pages	1,488	A town had more than one main page.
WordPress's own history	630	A page was renamed in the past.

4. What each redirect does to the visitor

We compared what the visitor *asked for* against what they would *get*.

Result	URLs	Share
Different service, same town	46,539	87.7%
Different service, different town	2,684	5.1%
Same service, same town — correct	2,210	4.2%
Same service, different town	905	1.7%
Town could not be read	718	1.4%

Correct — same thing, same place
/location/chimney-sweep-in-st-helens-or/ → /location/chimney-sweep-st-helens-or/

Wrong — different job
/location/pellet-stove-service-in-lynn-ma/
→ /location/wood-burning-stove-installation-in-lynn-ma/
A pellet stove customer sent to a wood stove installation page.

Wrong — different city and state
/location/cleveland-chimney-sweep/ → /location/chimney-sweep-portland-oregon/
Cleveland, Ohio sent to Portland, Oregon. 524 clicks.

Why this matters. Google treats a redirect landing on an unrelated page as a broken page and passes none of the value across. **92.8% of approved redirects send the visitor to a different service** than the one they searched for. Only 2,210 are a clean like-for-like move.

Good news. The 49,223 different-service redirects are not 49,223 separate decisions. They collapse into **4,403 service pairs**. Deciding “does chimney sweep forward to chimney sweep repair?” once fixes hundreds of URLs at a time.

The 36,759 retirements, and what this means

5. What the “GONE” URLs actually are

Category	URLs	What it is
Never existed	30,854	Not in WordPress at all. Already returns “not found” today.
Duplicate copy	5,035	A live page with WordPress’s -2 suffix.
A real published page	603	Live page, no duplicate marker.
Disagreement	239	Our check says this should not be retired.
A town’s main page	19	A working town hub page. Worth questioning.
Existed, never published	9	In WordPress as another type of item.

Never existed

/location/duct-cleaning-in-northbrook-il/
already “not found” – 0 clicks, 1,744 Google views

Duplicate copy

/location/air-duct-cleaning-in-ca-27/
“Air Duct Cleaning in Jackson, CA” – a second copy

Town’s main page

/location/chimney-sweep-repair-in-glen-ellyn-il/
live and working – should this really be retired?

One claim we had to correct. We were told this group had zero Google traffic. Not true: **32,347 have views and 1,972 have clicks.** But the amounts are small, and that matters too — 34,787 have no clicks, 1,955 have 1–4, and only **17 have 5 or more.** The highest earner has 13 clicks and is a PDF, not a page. Retiring all 36,759 costs about 2,445 clicks out of 75,524 site-wide, roughly 3%. **The decision is sound; the reason given for it was wrong.**

6. If we change the URL pattern

Proposal: change /location/{service}-in-{city}-{state}/ to /{state}/location/{city}/{service}/ . We tested whether it can actually be built.

Result	URLs	Share
Can be converted automatically	218,322	95.1%
Needs a person to decide first	11,318	4.9%

The 11,318 are the same broken ones from page 1 — duplicate copies, missing cities, editing notes. They carry **1,701 clicks and 522,038 Google views**, so they are not throwaway pages. A further **302 collisions** would occur, where two or three old URLs become one new URL.

The bigger issue. Changing every URL means every existing redirect points at an address that has itself moved. Redirect rules to maintain go from **53,056 to 282,696** — more than five times as many — and the current set already has problems on 96% of its rows.

Recommendation: change one thing at a time.

- Step 1** — Move to the new website. Keep every URL exactly as it is.
- Step 2** — Fix the ~11,000 broken addresses in WordPress.
- Step 3** — Settle the service list (208 names for 92 services).
- Step 4** — Then restructure, on a clean base, as its own release.

Steps 2 and 3 are already on the plan. Doing them first turns a 95% conversion into a 100% one.